His most famous failed experiments were the shifting of his capital from Delhi to Daulatabad (Devagiri in present-day Maharashtra) and the demonetization of gold and silver coins, replacing them with token coins of brass and copper. Both decisions wreaked havoc on his hapless populace. In 1327, having ordered the entire population of Delhi to march 1,500 km to Daulatabad, he reversed his decision in 1335, and reordered his people to return to Delhi. Thousands died on both journeys, and in the meanwhile, Delhi, which had been deserted, was laid to ruin.

Tughlaq's demonetization decision was just as disastrous. Counterfeit coins flooded the market, and the brass and copper coins became valueless, while hyperinflation soared. In an attempt to stem the economic chaos that resulted, Tughlaq was forced to withdraw the token currency. As a result of public resentment and economic bankruptcy, by the time of his death, Tughlaq's kingdom had shrunk to a small region around Delhi. A Tughlaqi firmaan has thus become a synonym for a grand, but poorly thought-out and badly executed policy measure that results in hardship and suffering for the common people.

Others compared notebandi to nasbandi, the infamous and flawed sterilization campaign undertaken by the former Prime Minister, Indira Gandhi, in an attempt to curb India's population growth.[1]

During the Emergency imposed by Indira Gandhi in 1975, an ambitious population control programme was undertaken. Labelled as a 'family-planning programme', vasectomy or nasbandi was forcibly performed. It is reported that 6.2 million Indian men were sterilized that year, amongst them teenagers and old men.[2] At least 2,000 men reportedly died in the process. In the 1977 elections, Indira Gandhi was decisively voted out of power and lost her own parliamentary seat. This was attributed to the unpopular Emergency measures, among which nasbandi was high on the list.

We may never know what the current Prime Minister's motives were for the 2016 demonetization, just as it is hard to discover the